



CHAPTER 14

An Act to provide for raising further money for the development of the postal, telegraphic and telephonic systems and of any other business of the Post Office; to make provision with respect to the application of sums arising from the sale of property acquired for the purposes of the Post Office; and for purposes connected with the matters aforesaid.

[22nd November, 1955]

BE it enacted by the Queen's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:—

1.—(1) Without prejudice to the exercise of any powers previously given for the like purpose, the Treasury may issue out of the Consolidated Fund such sums, not exceeding in the whole the sum of one hundred and seventy-five million pounds, as may be required by the Postmaster-General, according to estimates approved by the Treasury, for the development of the postal, telegraphic and telephonic systems and of any other business of the Post Office.

Grant for development of postal, telegraphic and telephonic systems and other Post Office business.

(2) The Treasury may, if they think fit, for the purpose of providing money for sums so authorised to be issued out of the Consolidated Fund, or for repaying to that Fund all or any part of the sums so issued, borrow—

(a) by means of terminable annuities for a term not exceeding twenty years; or

(b) in any other manner in which they are authorised to raise money under the National Loans Act, 1939,

and all sums so borrowed shall be paid into the Exchequer.

2 & 3 Geo. 6.
c. 117.

(3) Any annuities created and issued under paragraph (a) of the last foregoing subsection shall be paid out of moneys provided by Parliament for the service of the Post Office, and if those moneys are insufficient shall be charged on and paid out of the Consolidated Fund; and any other securities created and issued to raise money under that subsection shall be deemed for all purposes to be created and issued under the National Loans Act, 1939.

(4) So much of the sums issued under subsection (1) of this section as exceeds the amount borrowed in the manner mentioned in paragraph (a) of subsection (2) of this section shall be repaid to the Exchequer out of moneys provided by Parliament for the service of the Post Office at such times and by such methods as the Treasury may direct, and interest thereon at such rates and at such times as the Treasury may direct shall be paid into the Exchequer out of such moneys.

(5) Sums paid into the Exchequer under the last foregoing subsection shall be issued out of the Consolidated Fund at such times as the Treasury may direct and shall be applied by the Treasury as follows, that is to say,—

(a) so much thereof as represents principal shall be applied in redeeming or paying off debt of such description as the Treasury think fit;

(b) so much thereof as represents interest shall be applied towards meeting such part of the annual charges for the National Debt as represents interest.

14 Geo. 6. c. 2. (6) Subsection (3) of section two of the Post Office and Telegraph (Money) Act, 1950 (which requires the Postmaster-General to prepare an annual account of all sums issued under section one of that Act and of all expenditure from sums so issued) shall extend to this section.

Application of
sums arising
from sale of
Post Office
assets.

2.—(1) Sums arising from the sale of any property acquired for the purposes of the Post Office, whether or not acquired out of moneys provided under an Act authorising the raising of moneys for the development of any business of the Post Office, may, if the Treasury so direct, be treated as if they had been raised under any such Act which may for the time being be in force, and be applied accordingly for any of the purposes specified in that Act:

Provided that, where any such sums are so applied, the amount authorised to be raised under that Act shall be correspondingly reduced.

(2) The Telegraph (Money) Act, 1924 (which makes provision 14 & 15 Geo. 5. as to the application of sums arising from the sale of telephone c. 25. assets) is hereby repealed.

3. This Act may be cited as the Post Office and Telegraph Short title. (Money) Act, 1955.

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